

God Existence

doc-god-existence

Theology Proper · Existence · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

breadth canon-wide
directness direct
variants not in scope

Statement under examination

The one true and living God exists eternally as the self-existent creator and sustainer of all things.

In plain language

Across Hebrew and Greek the canon never argues that God exists. It presupposes it from the first clause. Genesis opens with 'create' (bara), an ongoing-result completed-action verb in the simple form whose subject is simply 'God' (Elohim), with no linking verb 'is' and no predicate of existence offered, because none is needed. A direct check of the store shows 'create' (bara) in this sense occurs forty six times, and every create form has God as the actor; the only human subjects use a different stem meaning to clear or cut. Deuteronomy 6:4 binds the personal name 'LORD' (YHWH) to the word 'one' (echad), asserting singular divine reality at the center of the covenant confession. Romans 1:20 says God's 'eternal power' (aidios dynamis) and 'divine nature' (theiotes) are 'clearly perceived' (kathoratai) through the things made, leaving people without excuse. The line just before, Romans 1:18, is the key. It ends with 'suppress' (katecho), to hold down, picturing people who push down a truth they already have. So the words leave room for only one kind of divergence, suppressed knowledge, not honest doubt about whether God is there. Hebrews 11:6 boils the whole pattern down to one verb: the one coming to God must believe that 'he is' (estin), and that he rewards those who seek him. The texts that sound like denial confirm this. Psalm 14:1 and its near twin Psalm 53:2 put the words there is no God in the mouth of the 'fool' (nabal), then call that corruption, never the writer's own claim. Ecclesiastes 3:11 limits how much of God's work people can trace out but keeps God as the one who acts. First Corinthians 8:5 grants 'so-called gods' in human speech, then in the next breath names one God the Father. A concordance pass turns up no place where any narrator, in his own voice, says God does not exist. The pattern spans law, narrative, wisdom, and letters, and the words point one direction. That is why this lands as affirmed with high confidence, and why the only thing the vocabulary leaves open is suppression, not existence.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0259	אֶחָד	echad	one	944
H0369	אֵין	ayin	nothing	720
H0430	אֱלֹהִים	elohim	God	2,251
H1254	בָּרָא	bara	to create	46
H3068	יְהוָה	YHWH	LORD	6,041
H5036	נָבָל	nabal	foolish	16
H8064	שָׁמַיִם	shamayim	heaven	378
G0126	αἰῶς	aidios	eternal	4

G0379	ἀναπολόγητος	anapologetos	inexcusable	4
G1411	δύναμις	dynamis	power	238
G1510	εἰμί	eimi	to be	2,595
G1567	ἐκζητέω	ekzeteo	to seek out	14
G2305	θειότης	theiotes	divinity	2
G2316	θεός	theos	God	1,346
G2529	καθοράω	kathorao	to perceive	2
G2722	κατέχω	katecho	to hold back/fast	35
G2937	κτίσις	ktisis	creation	38
G3406	μισθαποδότης	misthapodotes	rewarder	2
G4100	πιστεύω	pisteuo	to trust (in)	482
G4161	ποίημα	poiema	workmanship	4
G5318	φανερός	phaneros	clear	36

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The canon nowhere argues that God exists; it presupposes it grammatically from the first clause. Genesis 1:1 opens with the verb 'create' (bara, Strong's H1254A, in the simple active form of the Hebrew verb, qal, in the perfect tense meaning a completed action whose result still stands, third person masculine singular) whose subject is 'God' (Elohim, H0430), and no linking verb 'is' (copula) or predicate of existence is supplied because none is needed. Querying the store, 'create' (bara, H1254A) occurs 46 times; the 35 simple-active (qal) and 8 passive (niph'al) forms all have God as actor or implied agent, and the only 3 human-subject forms (Joshua 17:15, Joshua 17:18, Ezekiel 23:47) are in the intensive form (piel) meaning to cut down or clear, a distinct sense. Deuteronomy 6:4 binds the covenant name 'YHWH' (the personal name of God, H3068) and 'God' (Elohim) with 'one' (echad, H0259), predicating singular reality. Romans 1:20 says his 'eternal' (aidios, G0126) 'power' (dynamis, G1411) and 'divine nature' (theiotes, G2305) are 'clearly perceived' (kathoratai, G2529) through 'the things made' (ta poiemata, G4161), leaving humanity 'without excuse' (anapologetos, G0379). Crucially Romans 1:18 closes with 'those suppressing' (katechonton, G2722, meaning to hold down or restrain), so the text frames the only divergence as suppressed knowledge, not honest doubt. Hebrews 11:6 reduces saving faith to 'he is' (estin, G1510, an ongoing, simple statement of fact in the present tense). The lemmas form one assertion spread across the whole Bible (pan-canonical) with no counter-witness in any author's own voice.

Scripture

Gen.1.1 · for · genre: narrative · figures: merism

Key terms. H1254A בָּרָא, H0430 אֱלֹהִים, H8064 שָׁמַיִם.

Force. The opening verb 'create' (bara) is morphology code HVqp3ms, that is, the simple active form of the Hebrew verb (qal) in the perfect tense meaning a completed action whose result still stands, third person masculine singular, with 'God' (Elohim, morph HNcmpa, plural in form) as its singular subject. The singular verb governs the plural-form noun, so the grammar treats 'God' (Elohim) as one subject. No linking verb 'is' (copula) and no predicate of existence is offered; the verse asserts an act of the already existing God upon the heavens (shamayim) and the earth, a two-part figure naming the extremes to mean the whole (a merism). Of the 46 canon occurrences of 'create' (bara, Strong's H1254A), every simple-active form (qal) and passive form (niphal) has God as actor or implied agent, and the only human-subject forms are in the intensive form (piel) meaning to clear or cut, so the 'create' sense presupposes the divine subject.

Deut.6.4 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H3068 יְהוָה, H0430 אֱלֹהִים, H0259 אֶחָד.

Force. The Shema (the central confession 'Hear, O Israel') places 'hear' (shema, Strong's H8085, in the simple active command form, qal imperative) over the clause 'YHWH eloheinu YHWH echad', that is, 'The LORD our God, the LORD is one'. The personal name 'LORD' (YHWH, H3068) occurs twice, 'God' (Elohim) carries the first common plural suffix meaning 'our God', and 'one' (echad, H0259) predicates singular reality. The store tags the closing element as predicate complement (the word completing the 'X is Y' statement), so existence and unique identity are asserted in one breath. No rival deity is treated as real; the construction presupposes the named God and predicates his oneness.

Rom.1.19 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2316 θεός, G5318 φανερός

Force. Paul says 'what is knowable of God' (to gnoston tou theou) 'is manifest in them' (phaneron en autois, from theos and phaneros), because 'God made it manifest' (ho theos ephanerosen). The same 'manifest' (phaner) stem governs 'God' (theos) as both source and object, grounding knowledge of God in God's own disclosure. The verb is not an inference toward an uncertain conclusion but a statement that the datum is already plain.

Rom.1.20 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0126 αἰδιος, G2305 θεϊότης, G1411 δύναμις, G4161 ποιήμα, G2937 κτίσις, G0379 ἀναπολόγητος

Force. 'His invisible attributes' (ta aorata autou), namely 'his eternal power and divine nature' (he aidios dynamis kai theiotes, from aidios meaning eternal, dynamis meaning power, and theiotes meaning divine nature), 'are perceived' (kathoratai, from kathorao) by 'the things made' (ta poiemata, from poiema) 'since the founding of the world' (apo ktiseos kosmou, from ktisis meaning creation). The participle 'being understood' (nooumena) makes the perceiving a mental act. The result clause 'so that they are without excuse' (eis to einai autous anapologetous, from anapologetos) renders people without defense. The rare terms are not a word that occurs only once in the entire Bible (hapax): 'eternal' (aidios) occurs 4 times, 'divine nature' (theiotes) and 'clearly perceive' (kathorao) and 'thing made' (poiema) twice each, but here they converge to ground God's existence in created reality.

Rom.1.18 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2722 κατέχω, G2316 θεός

Force. The sentence that introduces the disclosure ends with the genitive participle 'of those suppressing the truth in unrighteousness' (katechonton ten aletheian en adikia, from katecho). The lemma 'suppress' (katecho, Strong's G2722, 35 canon occurrences) means to hold down or restrain. This is the lexical hinge: the text does not picture an honest agnostic who lacks the datum but a knower who pushes a present truth down. So the only divergence the words allow is suppressed knowledge, not genuine textual doubt about whether God ('theos') is.

Heb.11.6 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4100 πιστεύω, G1510 εἰμί, G1567 ἐκζητέω, G3406 μισθαποδότης

Force. The clause 'the one coming to God must believe that he is' (pisteusai dei ton proserchomenon to theo hoti estin, from pisteuo meaning to believe and eimi meaning to be) makes the bare predication 'he is' (estin) the floor of saving faith. The store parses 'is' (estin) as the verb 'to be' (eimi) in the present active indicative third singular, that is, an ongoing, simple statement of fact in the present tense. The follow clause 'and he becomes a rewarder of those who seek him out' (kai tois ekzetousin auton misthapodotes ginetai, from ekzeteo meaning to seek out and misthapodotes meaning rewarder) joins bare existence to personal character, so the existence claimed is of a moral agent, not an abstract first cause.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Gen.1.1	John.1.1	openbible	365
Gen.1.1	Heb.11.3	openbible	268
Gen.1.1	Isa.45.18	openbible	240
Gen.1.1	Exod.20.11	openbible	150
Deut.6.4	Mark.12.29	openbible	77
Deut.6.4	Isa.44.6	openbible	42
Deut.6.4	1Tim.2.5	openbible	35
Rom.1.20	Rom.1.19	openbible	56
Rom.1.20	Ps.19.1	openbible	42
Rom.1.20	Ps.33.6	openbible	26
Heb.11.6	Jer.29.13	openbible	157
Heb.11.6	1Chr.28.9	openbible	86
Heb.11.6	Heb.7.25	openbible	60

Complicating texts

Ps.14.1 · addressed

'The fool said in his heart there is no God' (amar nabal belibbo eyn elohim, from nabal meaning fool, eyn meaning there is not, and elohim meaning God). The store tags 'fool' (nabal, Strong's H5036) as an adjective and 'there is not' (eyn, H0369) as a construct negation particle (a word that negates 'there is'). The denial is reported speech placed in the mouth of the fool (nabal) and immediately glossed as moral corruption, 'they act corruptly' (hishchitu hit'ivu), not as the author's own predication. So it is not a counter-witness to existence but a verdict on those who deny it.

Ps.53.2 · addressed

This verse repeats Psalm 14:1 almost word for word, 'the fool said in his heart there is no God' (amar nabal belibbo eyn elohim), in a second collection. The doubling shows the canon treats atheistic speech as a recurring instance of folly, the same negation particle 'there is not' (eyn) applied to 'God' (elohim), again voiced by the fool (nabal). The repetition strengthens rather than weakens the pattern, since the only voice that says God is not is the named fool, never the narrator.

Eccl.3.11 · addressed

Qohelet (the Preacher, the speaker of Ecclesiastes) says God set 'the world or duration' (haolam, the word can mean either the world or duration of time) in the human heart, yet man cannot find out 'the work' (maaseh) that God does from beginning to end. The verb 'to do' or 'to make' (asah, Strong's H6213) keeps God as the subject who acts and makes. This limits exhaustive human knowledge of God's works but presupposes the divine agent throughout, so it qualifies comprehension, not existence.

1Cor.8.5 · addressed

Paul concedes 'so-called gods' (legomenoi theoi, from theos) and 'many gods' (theoi polloi) in human speech and pagan practice. The participle 'so-called' (legomenoi) marks them as named, not real. In 1 Corinthians 8:6 he fixes the referent as 'one God the Father' (heis theos ho pater), 'from whom are all things' (ex hou ta panta). The plural is rhetorical foil that he immediately collapses into the one true God (theos), so it does not predicate rival existence in his own voice.

Concordance traversed

H1254A, H0430, H3068, H0259, H8064, H0369, H5036, G2316, G0126, G2305, G1411, G2937, G4161, G5318, G2529, G0379, G2722, G1567, G4100, G3406, G1510

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

No variant units in the bundle and the anchors lie outside the ingested critical edition of New Testament textual variants (ECM apparatus) window of 3 John 1:1 to 1:15, so this is not in ECM scope. Genesis 1:1, Deuteronomy 6:4, Romans 1:18 to 20, and Hebrews 11:6 carry no textual variant of a size that touches the predication of divine existence. The bare verbs 'create' (bara) and 'is' (estin) and the negation 'there is not' (eyn) are stable across the major Hebrew and Greek witnesses, so the verdict is invariant.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. natural_theology, covenant_monotheism, presuppositional_reading

analogia scripturae invoked

natural_theology: affirms, grounded in general revelation · Romans 1:20 names creation as the medium, 'since the founding of the world, by the things made' (apo ktiseos kosmou tois poiemasin, from ktisis and poiema), and the human mind as the receiver, 'being understood, they are clearly perceived' (nooumena kathoratai, from kathorao), so the existence datum is read as available to all people through the things made, independent of special revelation.

covenant_monotheism: affirms, grounded in the revealed covenant name · Deuteronomy 6:4 ties 'one' (echad) to 'the LORD our God' (YHWH eloheinu, from YHWH and elohim), predicating singular existence of the named covenant God rather than a generic deity, so existence is read as inseparable from revealed identity. Read in its strongest form, this lens holds that the canon never argues to a bare deity but always presupposes the personal God who names himself.

presuppositional_reading: affirms, grounded in grammatical presupposition · Genesis 1:1 supplies no predicate of existence and no argument; 'God' (Elohim) is simply the subject of the first finite verb. On this lens the canon never sets out to prove God exists, it begins from it and treats denial as folly (Psalm 14:1) or suppression (Romans 1:18), so the existence claim is foundational rather than concluded. A reader holding this lens would say the other two lenses describe how the presupposed God is recognized, not how he is first established.

All three lenses reach 'affirms' and the lexical evidence does not require ranking them. They differ only on where the existence claim is anchored, in created order, in covenant name, or in grammatical presupposition, and the texts present these as complementary rather than competing.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. Does the canon, read at the level of its own Hebrew and Greek wording, assert that the one God exists as self-existent maker and sustainer, or does it leave that an open question?

The stem encodes several conclusions in confessional vocabulary: one true and living God, self-existent, eternal, creator and sustainer of all things. 'Self-existent' and 'eternal' are not single canon lemmas but composites, 'self-existent' paraphrasing the divine name and the unargued subject of 'create' (bara), 'eternal' resting on 'eternal' (aidios) in Romans 1:20. The verdict is derived on the original stem, but the neutralized_form strips the loaded predicates so the lexical test is whether the words assert God's existence at all, which they do by pervasive presupposition. VERDICT-CHANGED: no, the verdict is unchanged from the prior file; the lexical evidence still yields affirms, high confidence.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Gen.1.1
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.6.4
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.14.1
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.1.18
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.1.20
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.11.6
lexicon	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1254A
lexicon	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0126
lexicon	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2722
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2305
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Gen.1.1
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Deut.6.4
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Rom.1.20
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Heb.11.6

License audit

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Source	License	Redistribute
OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes

Flags

(none)